

Random Acts of Kindness [B1]

Rendere felici gli altri non costa molto: un sorriso o un complimento possono migliorare la giornata di chiunque. Per questo, 30 anni fa è stata istituita una giornata per celebrare questi atti di altruismo.



Can you remember a time when someone held open a door for you? Or when someone let you jump the queue when you [were in a hurry](#)? Or when you [dropped](#) your bag on the street and a [passerby](#) helped you [pick up](#) the contents? Such [random](#) acts of kindness can [lift your mood](#), leaving you with a warm feeling that lasts all day.

A DAY OF KINDNESS

There is a date in the US calendar on which such gestures are particularly encouraged. 17 February is known as Random Acts of Kindness Day. The initiative serves as a reminder that these small but [meaningful](#) acts have the power to change the world. The idea is to create a more compassionate and [caring](#) society, by [spreading](#) love and positivity.

THE START OF A MOVEMENT

It all started some forty years ago in the US, in the San Francisco Bay area. The phrase was [coined](#) by journalist Anne Herbert in 1982, who wrote about “[random](#) acts of kindness and acts of [senseless](#) beauty.” Herbert could not have imagined that her ideas would [trigger](#) a worldwide movement. The words were painted on walls, discussed in classrooms and written about in the media. [Slowly but surely](#), the message spread.

RAK DAY IS BORN

Herbert published an illustrated children’s book on the same theme in 1993. It was received with enthusiasm by children and adults [alike](#). Local Random Acts of Kindness Days [grew into](#) an annual celebration in the US. While the first event was funded by the book’s publisher, Conari Press, a [nonprofit](#) foundation was created in 1995 to organise future celebrations.

RAKTIVISM

The Random Acts of Kindness Foundation is on a mission to make kindness the norm. Besides the celebration on 17 February — the same week as Valentine’s Day — it also provides free resources for schools, workplaces, homes and communities. It encourages people to become RAKtivists ([short for](#) Random Acts of Kindness activists), who turn ordinary days into something special with small, [thoughtful](#) gestures — like a bright smile or offering a seat on the bus.

KINDNESS AS A WAY OF LIFE

The movement gets bigger every year. Influencers share content on social media. Celebrities are judged by how kind they are to others. Corporates are [eagerto join in](#). Last year, Krispy Kreme gave out free doughnuts. It has now spread to New Zealand, where it is observed on 1 September. The ultimate goal is to make it a way of life. The foundation is hopeful: “Together, we can make the world a better place, [one act of kindness at a time](#).”

Glossary

- **passerby** = passante
- **caring** = premuroso, attento
- **spreading** = diffondere
- **coined** = coniare
- **senseless** = insensato
- **to join in** = unirsi a
- **dropped** = fare cadere
- **random** = fortuito
- **lift your mood** = sollevare l'umore
- **meaningful** = significativi
- **grew into** = trasformarsi in
- **short for** = abbreviazione di
- **thoughtful** = premurosi
- **Slowly but surely** = lentamente ma indubbiamente
- **were in a hurry** = avere fretta
- **pick up** = raccogliere
- **trigger** = scatenare
- **nonprofit** = senza scopo di lucro
- **eager** = desiderosi
- **one act of kindness at a time** = uno alla volta
- **alike** = allo stesso modo